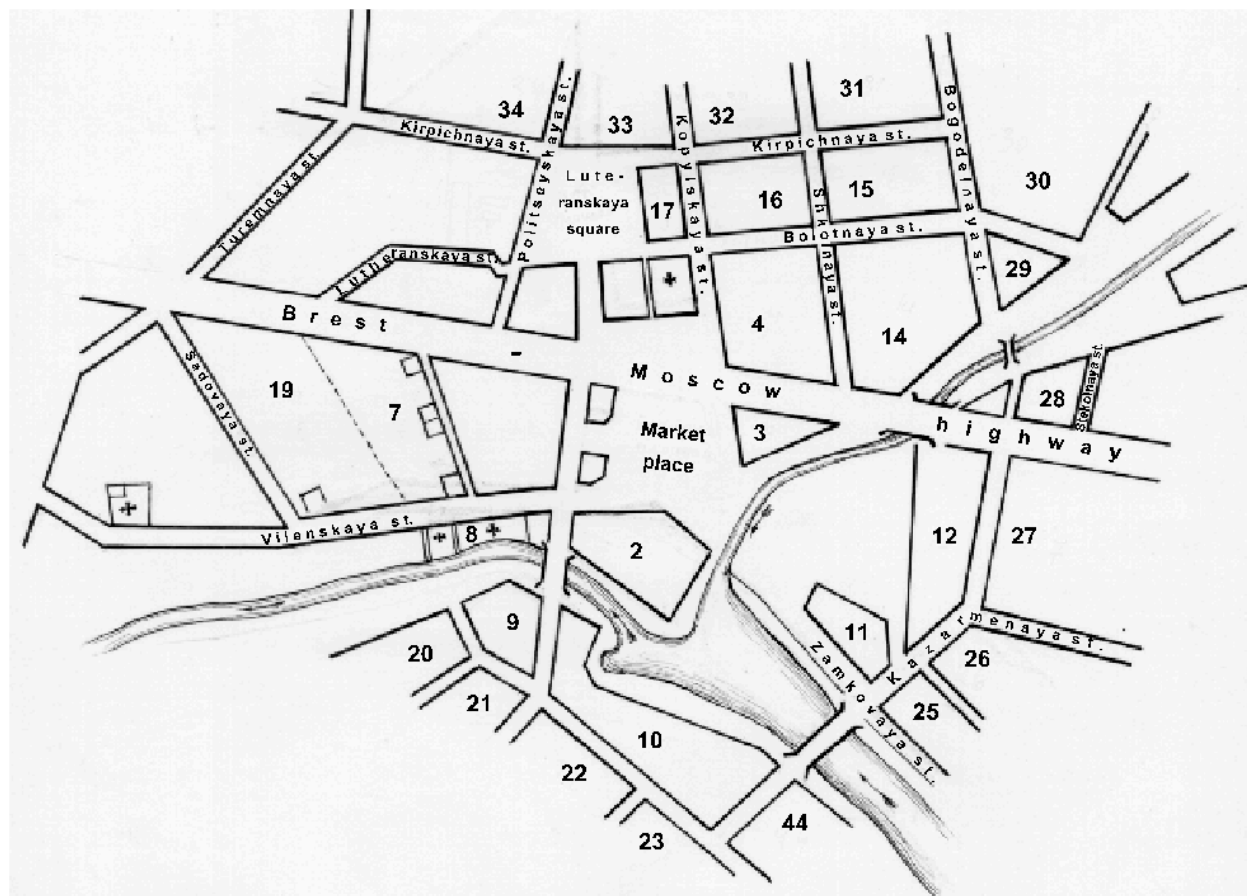
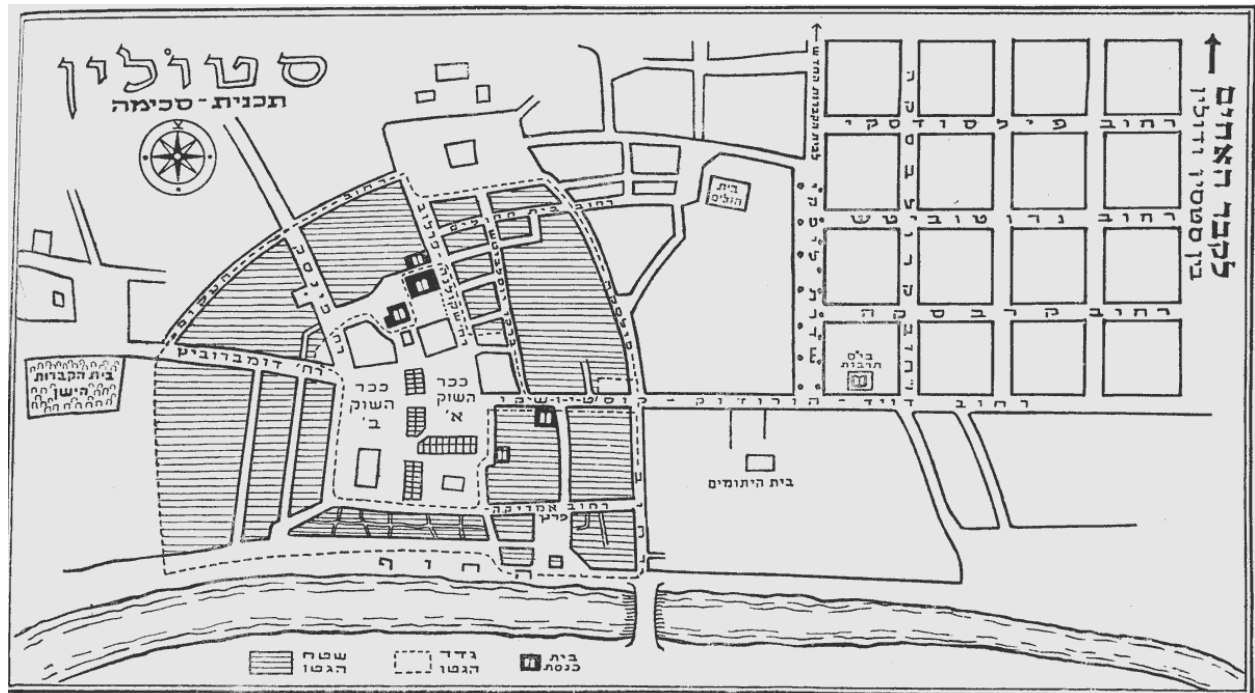


<https://archive.org/details/nybc314001/mode/2up> Slutsk Yizkor Book

<https://www.jewishgen.org/yizkor/slutsk/slutsk.html#TOC-Eng>

https://www.jewishgen.org/belarus/lists/Slutsk_history_of_jewish_community.htm





Gravestone 17

Here

is interred Our Teacher, Rabbi Yechiel

Michel son of Our Teacher, Rabbi Ary(eh)

who died on 11 Cheshvan in the year (of)

5628 (= 10 November 1867) may he rest in peace.

<https://www.jewishgen.org/Belarus/lists/OGGravestones.htm>

<https://culture.pl/en/article/phantom-snapshots-from-the-polish-belarusian-border> Sapotskin
photographs



Fayvl the Town Sexton

Fayvl Harakh [Charach] was born a sexton. His father Reb Aaron, the Jewish Court of Justice sexton, died young and left his widow, Esther Frume, with four small children, and the community, in respect for him, turned over the position of sexton to Fayvl. He was then only fourteen years old. He had a good head for studying, but he had no desire to take over as sexton. But this was the only way to feed his mother and the small orphans. So Fayvl, at fourteen, became the Court of Justice sexton and also "assistant sexton" for the *Kalter shul*. Several years later, when Reb Hirschl, the "head sexton" of the *Kalter shul*, left for America, Fayvl became the head sexton. Nevertheless Fayvl was very busy with city affairs, so he was never separated from his holy books, knew the *Tanach*, and was well versed in " *Ein Jankev*."

As sexton for the Court of Justice, he usually managed to spend a large amount of his time around the rabbi. The rabbi, Rabbi Iser Zelman, would turn to him with questions: "Where is this verse or that tractate of our Sages of Blessed Memory to be found?"

When Liate, the sexton from the Butchers' *shul*, died, Fayvl immediately began to say " *Ein Jankev*" there between afternoon prayers and evening services, but not for money, God forbid.

Fayvl was a smart Jew and always happy. He had a good heart and everyone respected him. In the 1920s when the Bolsheviks had already naturally requisitioned all the synagogues and did not have any place for sextons, Fayvl purchased a horse and wagon and drove loads around town and once in a while took a passenger to the train station. But his livelihood was mainly derived from bringing kegs of water and selling it to the Soviet restaurants, even though the leaders were aware of his "bourgeois past" as sexton.

In 1930, after Trotsky's downfall, when the "*Cheka*" [Soviet secret police] made up stories to get rid of anyone on whom there fell the least bit of "Trotskyism," a certain Jewish Communist, a Trotskyist, was arrested in Slutsk. There was little to remind people of him but he left behind a young wife with several small children.

<https://www.jewishgen.org/yizkor/slutsk/slu305.html#page308>